



THE RETURN OF A LAKE ONTARIO ICON

Restoring Atlantic Salmon to Lake Ontario

OUR GOAL

Restore Atlantic Salmon and support a diverse salmon and trout fishery.

The program is working to restore Atlantic Salmon to their historical home in Lake Ontario while building a unique recreational fishery that supports Ontario's economy. At the same time, it improves critical habitat that strengthens biodiversity and honours the lake's cultural heritage. Through the OFAH Classroom Hatchery Program, this initiative also invests in the future by connecting thousands of students along Lake Ontario's north shore with hands-on learning in salmon biology, conservation, and stewardship.

WHY THIS MATTERS

Better habitat. Better fishing. A better lake.

Atlantic Salmon are returning to the fishery in record numbers. An adaptive management approach informed by more than 15 years of program experience guides targeted stocking, efforts to increase adult abundance, and continued investment in tributary habitat restoration and enhancement. These habitat projects benefit all fish and wildlife across the Lake Ontario watershed, supporting a fishery that offers incredible shoreline and tributary opportunities for anglers alongside a productive offshore boat fishery.

Ontario's Five Priorities

01	02	03	04	05
Increase adult Atlantic Salmon abundance in Lake Ontario	Continue to improve habitat in priority watersheds	Focus on stocking of spring and fall yearling life stage	Enhance Atlantic Salmon recreational angling opportunities	Improve communication and awareness of program direction

A Lake-Wide Approach

Fish do not recognize borders, and neither does the Lake Ontario Atlantic Salmon restoration effort. Through an Ontario-United States

Progress at a Glance:

Lake-wide Catch Rates Increasing

Anglers across the lake are recording Atlantic Salmon catches at increasing rates.

binational partnership, partners coordinate stocking, habitat work, and science across Lake Ontario.

Catch rates are climbing. Anglers across the lake are recording catches of Atlantic Salmon. Restoration efforts are supporting a strong, diverse salmon and trout fishery with accessible nearshore and tributary angling opportunities alongside a productive offshore fishery.

Biologists are also capturing and sampling returning adults to guide future restoration. With more than 300 adults sampled over the past three years, biologists now have the best look at this population in a generation, helping guide restoration and stocking efforts.



Report Your Catch

Help track returning Atlantic Salmon. Submit your observations and catches to info@bringbackthesalmon.ca or visit bringbackthesalmon.ca.

Increasing Adult Returns

Returning Atlantic Salmon captured and studied in the past three years.

150⁺

Habitat projects

Stream and watershed improvements delivered by OFAH and partners.

1,500⁺

Students reached

Through the OFAH Classroom Hatchery & outreach program.

50⁺

Partner organizations

Working together on fish production, habitat restoration, and outreach.

What We're Doing on the Water

CURRENT PROJECTS

FISH PRODUCTION

Stocking Atlantic Salmon at the size where survival, returns, and restoration impact come together.

HABITAT RESTORATION

Improving streams, shorelines, and watersheds. Work that benefits all fish and wildlife across Lake Ontario.

SCIENCE & MONITORING

Tracking returning fish with tags, cameras, and angler surveys to guide better decisions.

EDUCATION & OUTREACH

Engaging anglers, students, and the public through OFAH-led programs across Ontario.

DELIVERED IN PARTNERSHIP

Ontario Ministry of Natural Resources · Ontario Federation of Anglers and Hunters

Learn more. Get involved.
BRINGBACKTHESALMON.CA